Unit 12A · A clever baby!

Speaking · 12 sets · for the teacher

How to use it. Pick a set, read the questions, point to the words. Let students answer in their own way: the green line is only a model. The first sets push today's grammar, the middle sets bring back older grammar, and the last sets are open and creative.

1 When I was a baby

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **curly / straight hair** · brown eyes · cheerful · shy

Tell me about your hair when you were a baby.
→ When I was a baby, I had curly hair. It was dark brown.

Were you a cheerful baby or a quiet baby?
→ I was a cheerful baby. I wasn't shy. I was always happy.

Who was with you? Was he or she friendly?
→ My mom and my grandma were with me. They were very friendly.

What was your favorite toy?
→ My favorite toy was a small brown bear. It had big black eyes.

2 My grandparents

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **tall** · short · handsome · pretty · glasses · beard

Was your grandpa tall or short?
→ He was tall. He had a gray beard and glasses.

Tell me about your grandma when she was young.
→ She was pretty. She had long black hair and brown eyes.

Was she cheerful? Was she generous?
→ Yes, she was. She was always very generous. She had sweets in her bag!

Do you take after your grandma or your grandpa?
→ I take after my grandpa. We both have curly hair and we are funny.

3 My first day at school

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **worried** · shy · friendly · teacher · school bag

Were you worried on your first day?
→ Yes, I was. I was a little shy, but I wasn't scared.

What was your teacher like?
→ She was friendly and cheerful. She had short blond hair.

Tell me about your school bag. What was in it?
→ There was a notebook, two pencils and a sandwich.

Were the other kids friendly?
→ Yes, they were. We were all small, and nobody was mean.

4 Yesterday

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **hot** · cold · at home · at the park · with my friends

Where were you yesterday at five o'clock?
→ I was at the playground with my friends.

What was the weather like?
→ It was sunny and warm. It wasn't cold.

Was it a good day? Why?
→ Yes, it was. We were together and we weren't bored.

Who wasn't at school yesterday?
→ Emir wasn't at school. He was sick.

5 A hundred years ago

IMAGINE

Push these words: **there was / there were** · horse · carriage · no planes

What wasn't there in our town a hundred years ago?
→ There weren't any cars. There wasn't a mall.

What was there? What were there?
→ There was a market. There were lots of horses and carts.

Were the children's clothes the same as now?
→ No, they weren't. They didn't have jeans or sneakers.

Was school the same? Why not?
→ No, it wasn't. They didn't have computers, but they had big books.

6 You are a king or a queen

IMAGINE

Push these words: **castle** · generous · mean · crown · servant

Imagine you are a king long ago. Tell me what you had.
→ I had a big castle, a golden crown and a hundred servants.

Was your life easy?
→ No, it wasn't. I had a lot of work, and I wasn't free.

Were you generous or mean? Give an example.
→ I was generous. There was food for everybody.

Tell us about your castle: Was there a garden? Were there towers?
→ There was a big garden, and there were four tall towers.

7 Rules in the park

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **must** · mustn't · litter · grass · quiet

What must you do in the park?
→ You must put litter in the trash can and you must be careful.

What mustn't you do on the grass?
→ You mustn't walk on the grass or pick the flowers.

Tell me a rule you had when you were small. (Use had.)
→ I had a rule: I mustn't play ball near the road.

What mustn't you do in a library? Why?
→ You mustn't shout, because other people are reading.

8 Describe a person

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **tall** · short · hair · eyes · friendly · looks like

What does your best friend look like?
→ He's tall and he has short brown hair. He has green eyes.

What's he like?
→ He's funny and friendly. He isn't shy.

What did he look like when he was five?
→ He was small, and he had very short hair.

Who in your family do you look like?
→ I look like my mom. We both have brown eyes.

9 Was life easier long ago?

OPINION

Push these words: **easier** · harder · I think · because · there wasn't

Was life easier long ago or is it easier now? Why?
→ I think it's easier now because we have phones and cars.

What was better long ago?
→ There weren't a lot of cars, so the air was cleaner.

Would you like to live a hundred years ago? Why or why not?
→ No, I wouldn't. There weren't any computers or movies!

What do you think: Were children happier then?
→ I think they were happy, because they played outside a lot.

10 Animals, then and now

OPINION

Push these words: **bigger** · fastest · dangerous · dinosaur · was / were

Were dinosaurs bigger than elephants? Which dinosaur do you like?
→ Some dinosaurs were bigger than elephants. I like the T-rex. It was scary.

Was a dinosaur dangerous? What did it have?
→ Yes, it was. It had big teeth and strong legs.

Which animal is the fastest in the world?
→ The cheetah is the fastest. It's faster than a horse.

Which animal is a good pet? Why?
→ A cat, because it's clean and friendly.

11 Fairy tales

IMAGINE

Push these words: **wolf** · goat · paws · tail · brave · clever

In Red Riding Hood, was the wolf friendly? Tell me about his eyes, ears and teeth.
→ No, he wasn't. He had big eyes, big ears and big teeth.

Was the little girl brave or shy?
→ She was brave, but she wasn't careful.

Imagine you meet the wolf. What do you say?
→ You mustn't eat my grandma! Go away!

Which fairy tale hero is the cleverest? Why?
→ The little goat, because it was careful.

12 My dream job

ABOUT ME

Push these words: **dream job** · pilot · doctor · vet

When you were five, what was your dream job?
→ When I was five, my dream job was a pilot.

What is your dream job now?
→ My dream job is a vet.

Why do you like this job?
→ Because I love animals.

Was your dad's dream job the same?
→ No, it wasn't. He wanted to be a driver.